

Contra VC - AI-Native Venture Capital

Strategic Blueprint

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1. Executive Summary

This document sets out the strategic blueprint and execution plan to build a leading AI-native venture capital firm from a standing start.

The opportunity is twofold and time-sensitive.

- First, a generational shift in software is underway: every category, from infrastructure to vertical application, is being re-platformed around foundation models. Capital is flowing to founders who are building this layer, but most of the capital is being deployed by firms whose operating model was built for a pre-AI world.
- Second, the venture firm itself can be re-engineered. Sourcing, due diligence, decision-making, portfolio support, and LP operations are all knowledge work that compounds with structured data, retrieval, and reasoning. A new firm that builds its operating model around these primitives, rather than retrofitting them, has a real and durable advantage.

Our positioning rests on three layers of AI advantage.

- The sourcing layer turns public signal — code, hiring, traffic, talent flows, technical depth — into a continuously refreshed view of who is building what and where conviction should compound.
- The judgment layer uses structured memory across every memo, conversation, and pass to make each new decision better than the last.
- The leverage layer extends into the operating footprint automating the work that does not require partner judgment.

Targets

First close by June 2026 – likely to spill over

Final close by December 2026

Five to seven investments deployed with documented decision rationale.

Founder NPS measured and credible.

Internal tooling that produces a measurable speed advantage in screening, sourcing, and DD.

Operating systems for better decision making across a geographically distributed team

What this document is not

This is not a fundraising deck. It is not an LP-facing document. It is the internal operating doctrine for the team — opinionated, specific, and intended to be debated and edited as reality teaches us things the plan does not yet know.

2. Strategic Vision: What “AI-Native” Means

2.1 The three layers of AI advantage

Sourcing layer

Most VCs source through warm intros, conferences, and inbound. This produces a slow, biased, network-bounded view of the world. An AI-native firm complements this with continuous structured ingestion of public signals: code repositories, hiring postings, traffic and product data, technical publications, founder histories, and customer chatter.

The output is a weekly target list of companies that match the thesis before they appear on any other VC’s radar. The advantage is not magical model performance; it is data structure, signal selection, and a feedback loop where every passed and won deal teaches the next ranking.

This can then be combined with the proprietary dealflow that we see as GPs.

Judgment layer

Most VC decision-making is relationship based, partner-memory dependent, and unaccountable.

An AI-native firm treats every memo, IC discussion, founder call (transcribed), and post-mortem as structured data that informs future decisions.

Retrieval over this corpus turns institutional memory from a function of partner tenure into a queryable asset.

Calibrated forecasting on each deal — what we expect, why, and what would change our mind — converts gut into trackable judgment that improves with feedback.

Leverage layer

The lion’s share goes to repetitive work: writing first-draft summaries, market sizing, scheduling, formatting memos, drafting LP updates, doing initial competitive maps. AI does not replace judgment, but it can take 60–70% of the time cost out of these tasks. That reclaimed time is what lets a four-person firm run with the operational surface area of a fifteen-person firm — without the dilution that comes from a fifteen-person partnership.

2.2 The trap to avoid: gimmick AI vs. durable advantage

Durable advantage requires three things, none of them glamorous: (1) proprietary data, structured and tagged from Day 1, that compounds with every deal; (2) eval discipline that catches model regressions before they show up externally; and (3) ruthless workflow integration, where AI is not a separate “tab” but the path of least resistance for the work the partners are already doing.

Note: We have been very bad at this. Need to start building discipline.

2.3 Why now

The window for an AI-native firm exists because the dominant funds are mid-cycle on legacy operating models. By the time those firms refactor (which most will, eventually), we want to have established the data, the relationships, and the founder trust that compounds. The next 18–24 months is the credible window to do this. After that, the differentiation narrows to brand and capital.

3. Values

- **We're a sports team, not a family** - High performance, clear roles, direct feedback. When someone needs support, we have open and constructive conversations.
- **Think long term, act short term** - We value making bold, but well-thought-out decisions and focus on first principles. Speed, focus, and discipline guide us.
- **Accountability and Communication is key** - Nothing is beyond or beneath you. Communicate proactively to set expectations. Accountability is about ownership and clarity.
- **Always founders first, not AI first** - We exist to solve for founders. If we do the right thing for the right founders everything will fall into place
- **Honesty & trust >> skills and numbers** - To ourselves, to the team and our stakeholders Do the right thing not the convenient thing

4. The 2-Month Roadmap

4.1 Phase 1: Foundation (DONE)

Defining question: Is the firm legally, operationally, and narratively ready to take LP money?

Track	Key outputs by end of Phase 1	Primary owner
Legal & structure	LPA drafted, mgmt co and GP entities formed, fund admin selected, banking live	Aabhas Khanna
Brand & positioning	Thesis articulated, name and website live, social and content engine started	Aabhas Khanna
AI infrastructure	Tech stack design doc, CRM (Fundingstack), sourcing pipeline (established from MyAsiaVC)	Aabhas Khanna
LP preparation	Target list (WIP), pitch deck v1, track record dossier complete	Aabhas Khanna

4.2 Phase 2: First Close & First Investments (WIP)

Defining question: Can we close the fund and start deploying with discipline?

Phase 2 is the highest-pressure phase.

Fundraising velocity needs to be at maximum.

Track	Key outputs by end of Phase 2	Primary owner
LP campaign	Anchor LP to be secured, first close at 20%% of target	Aabhas Khanna Sajid Rahman
Sourcing & origination	Scout Program to be launched, Partnerships formalised, VC communications	TBC
Deal execution	Standard term sheets, closing checklist, first investment closed	TBC
AI	Brief generator live, sourcing scoring model active, RAG over memos	TECH

4.3 Phase 3: Operationalise

Defining question: Can we deploy at the right pace, support founders well, and keep the LP momentum?

The discipline of this phase is to protect the process. We will resist the urge to invent new processes mid-stream, and instead instrument and tune what already exists.

Track	Key outputs by end of Phase 3	Primary owner
Deployment	3–5 investments closed, follow-on reserves policy active	TBC
Portfolio support	Customer intro engine live, talent/recruiting service offered, monthly cadence with each portco	TBC
LP operations	First quarterly LP letter sent, valuation policy adopted, capital call run cleanly	TBC
Fundraising	Final close campaign in flight; second close completed	TBC
AI	Internal Slack agent live, founder portal beta, eval discipline weekly	TBC

4.4 Phase 4: Institutionalize

Phase 4 is about converting a year of operational learning into durable institutional artifacts: a credible annual letter, a successful LP meeting, a clean audit, a documented decision-quality track record, and a Fund II narrative that is starting to compose itself.

Track	Key outputs by end of Phase 4	Primary owner
LP relationship	Annual LP meeting executed, year-end communications sent, references warm	TBC
Portfolio	5–7 investments deployed, founder NPS published, crisis playbook tested	TBC
Operations	Final close executed, annual audit started, K-1s on track	Aabhas Khanna
AI & data	LP reporting partially automated, portfolio data ingestion live, evals at SLA	TBC
Fund II prep	Track record packaged, story drafted, anchor conversations started	TBC

4. Workstream Blueprint

4.1 Brand & Positioning

Objective: Establish a distinctive market identity, supported by a content engine that produces inbound deal flow and LP credibility.

Key activities

- Sharp thesis: stage, sector(s), geography, check size, ownership target, and — critically — a point of view about the market that we are willing to defend in writing.
- Name, brand identity, website launched.
- Content engine: monthly long-form essay, weekly newsletter, weekly partner Twitter/X presence.
- PR launch coordinated with first close for maximum momentum effect.

AI angle

Content engine instrumented with LLMs for first-draft research, structuring, and editorial. The byline must be human and the POV must be human; the leverage is in the speed of moving from idea to published piece.

Top risks

- Generic positioning. “We back ambitious founders” is fatal. Force a position that some smart people will disagree with.
- Over-investment in design at the expense of substance. A simple, fast, opinionated site beats a beautiful generic one every time.

4.2 Fundraising (LP Engagement)

Key activities

- Tiered LP target list of 200–300, segmented by check size, AI/tech appetite, and decision speed.
- LP CRM with strict hygiene — every meeting logged within 24 hours.
- Pitch deck v1 with a story arc: market shift, thesis, edge, team, terms, ask. Iterate weekly post-meeting.
- Pre-fund track record with documented angel investments, scout deals, and attributed value-add.
- Rolling first close; momentum-building second close; final close strategy.

4.3 AI Infrastructure & Tech Stack

Objective: Ship a working AI-native operating layer that measurably accelerates sourcing, DD, and portfolio support by Month 2 — and that improves continuously through Year 1.

This workstream is the differentiator. It is also the workstream most likely to overrun budget and timeline if not managed with discipline. We address that in two ways: (a) buy where the market is mature, build only where there is a real edge to capture; (b) ship in slices, with weekly evals.

Key activities

- Tech stack design doc by Week 2, with build-vs-buy decisions made and documented.
- CRM (Fundingstack) live by Week 6 with email/calendar integration.
- Sourcing data pipeline ingesting public signals (LinkedIn, AQVC, Fundingstack, etc.) by Week 2.
- LLM-powered company brief generator by Week 5.
- RAG over internal memos and founder calls by Week 6.
- Internal Slack agent for queries and workflows by Week 6.

AI angle

This is the AI angle. The principle: every external-facing output (memos, LP letters, customer intros) is human-finalized; every internal-facing output (briefs, screens, queries) can be AI-finalized as long as evals are passing.

The eval discipline

What separates an AI-native firm from an AI-flavored one is the rigor of evals. We will define eval suites for sourcing rankings, brief generation, and agent responses, with weekly review. Without this, models silently degrade and we won't notice until something embarrassing happens externally.

4.4 Deal Origination

Objective: Build a multi-channel deal flow engine that consistently produces 100+ shortlisted opportunities per month, with a defined funnel and conversion tracking at each stage.

Key activities

- Codified Ideal Company Profile (ICP) with quantified criteria; ruthlessly enforced at the screen stage.
- Inbound channel optimization: website pitch form, 48-hour SLA on first response, transparent decline-with-reason.
- Outbound systematic sourcing: weekly AI-curated target list, personalized outreach, tracked conversion.
- Scout program: 10–20 scouts, operator-heavy, paid in carry, biweekly sync.
- Co-investor and syndicate relationships: map 40–60 co-investors, reciprocity log, preferred lead-vs-follow positions.
- University and accelerator partnerships: YC, Techstars, university tech transfer.
- Conference and event presence with specific meeting goals, not “see who I run into.”

4.5 Due Diligence

Objective: Make every investment decision with discipline calibrated to stage and check size — fast enough to win deals, deep enough to avoid the predictable losses.

Key activities

- DD playbook by stage: pre-seed, seed, Series A — each with calibrated depth.
- Sector DD frameworks for the 3–4 priority verticals: key questions, customer archetypes, competitive maps, technical risks.
- AI-assisted market sizing and competitive landscape generation, human-validated.
- Technical DD framework (the tech intern's killer differentiator): code review, architecture interview, AI/ML evaluation.
- Reference call playbook with on-list and off-list back-channeling protocols.
- Background check vendor and consent flow.
- Mock DD on three sample companies before live deals — stress-test the playbook.

AI angle

We need to build a very strong market layer to understand what is happening externally. AI will be critical for that

4.6 Investment Committee & Decisioning

Objective: Make and document every decision with clarity, calibration, and accountability — and learn from every one.

Key activities

- IC charter: composition (2 GPs + observer rotation), voting rule (unanimous, then 2-of-3 with senior advisor as tie-breaker), conflicts and recusal policy.
- Memo template: thesis fit, team, market, product, traction, deal terms, risks, recommendation, calibrated forecast.
- Pre-IC funnel: inbound → screen (24hr SLA) → first meeting → partner review → DD → IC. SLAs at each stage.
- Weekly IC cadence with pre-reads required 48 hours prior.
- Decision-quality tracking: every deal gets a calibrated forecast at IC; review accuracy quarterly.
- Anti-portfolio: track every pass; revisit quarterly; share with LPs as a transparency artifact.

4.7 Deal Execution

Objective: Close investments quickly, accurately, and with zero operational errors.

Key activities

- Standard deal docs templates: SAFE, convertible note, Series Seed; pre-negotiated for our investments.
- Closing checklist and doc-tracking template.
- Cap-table tracking; re-derive from source documents (founders often deliver inaccurate cap tables).
- Follow-on reserves policy: typical 1:2 initial-to-reserves ratio; pro-rata strategy; super-pro-rata triggers.

AI angle

LLM-assisted term sheet comparison and red-line review (cosmetic and structural diffs).

Cap-table verification against source documents.

4.8 Portfolio Management & Founder Support

Objective: Be the most useful early investor on a founder's cap table — measurably.

Key activities

- Customer intro engine: combined-network database, AI matching, structured intro requests (leverage MyAsiaVC Community)
- Talent and recruiting support: recruiter network, equity benchmarks, operator-network intros.
- Strategic partnership intros: cloud credits (Google, NVIDIA), design partners, distribution partners.
- Follow-on raise support playbook: deck review, investor list, narrative coaching, intro orchestration.
- Founder office hours weekly; structured monthly 1:1 with each portco CEO.
- Crisis playbook: down rounds, layoffs, founder conflict, regulatory issues, key-person departure.
- Quarterly anonymous founder NPS; publish results internally; act on them publicly.

AI angle

The customer intro engine is the highest-leverage AI application post-investment. Combined network graphs of the team plus scouts plus portfolio plus LPs, structured by role and industry, with AI matching against portfolio company asks, can produce intros at a velocity that no other emerging fund can match. This becomes a primary fundraising story for Fund II.

4.9 LP Reporting & Governance

Objective: Build LP trust through transparent, consistent, on-time communication and clean operational execution.

Key activities

- Quarterly LP letter template: fund update, deployment, portfolio highlights, market commentary, financials.
- Annual LP meeting with portfolio company speakers and anti-portfolio discussion.
- Annual audit and K-1 production.

5. The AI-Native Operating Model

This section steps back and describes the AI operating model as a coherent whole — what it looks like, what we build, what we buy, and how it compounds.

5.1 The five stacks

Stack 1: Sourcing

Inputs: public signals + linkedin + partnerships + founder network + LP network

Processing: structured ingestion, deduplication, scoring against ICP criteria.

Outputs: weekly target list of 25–50 companies for partner review, ranked by thesis fit and signal strength. Owner: TECH.

Eval: precision at top-20 measured monthly against partner judgment.

Stack 2: Due Diligence

Inputs: company URL, name, deck (if available), pitch transcript. Processing: brief generator (one-pager), market sizing (bottoms-up), competitive landscape (auto + human-validated), reference triangulation. Outputs: standardized DD package for IC. Owner: TECH + INV. Eval: factual accuracy on a held-out set of 20 sample companies, scored quarterly.

Stack 3: Decision-Making

Inputs: every memo, IC discussion (transcribed), founder call (transcribed and tagged), post-mortem, anti-portfolio entry.

Processing: vector store, structured tagging, semantic retrieval.

Outputs: in-IC retrieval of analogous past deals; quarterly calibration reports; anti-portfolio learnings.

Owner: GPs

Eval: retrieval relevance and partner-reported usefulness.

Stack 4: Portfolio Support

Inputs: combined network graph (team + scouts + LPs + portcos + advisors), structured intro requests, portfolio company metrics. Processing: AI matching, intro orchestration.

Outputs: warm intros at scale, customer/partner/hire matches, KPI alerts.

Owner: GPs.

Eval: intro acceptance rate, founder NPS on platform value.

Stack 5: Internal Operations

Inputs: emails, calendar, Slack, CRM, docs. Processing: agents (transcription, summarization, action-item extraction, follow-up drafting). Outputs: reclaimed partner hours, faster cycle times. Owner: TECH. Eval: hours saved per week per partner.

5.2 Build vs buy guidance

The default is buy. We build only where there is a defensible reason — typically because the integration or data structure is itself the moat.

Category	Default	Rationale
CRM, comms, fund admin, e-sign, identity	Buy	Mature markets; no edge to be gained by building.
Foundation models (LLM API)	Buy (Claude / GPT / Gemini)	Best foundation models will be commoditized. Multi-model routing for cost/quality.
Data ingestion (LinkedIn, Crunchbase, etc.)	Buy + light build	Buy API access where available; light scraping where not (with ToS compliance).
Sourcing signal scoring model	Build	This is our IP. Starts simple, compounds with deal feedback.
Company brief generator	Build	Differentiator. Standardized format with source attribution.
RAG over investment memos	Build	Internal data; tagging and structure are the moat.
Customer intro engine	Build	The network graph is firm-specific and a primary differentiator.
LP portal & reporting	Buy	LPs expect familiar interfaces. Don't build.

5.3 The data moat

Tools commoditize. Models commoditize. Data, when structured and accumulated with discipline, does not. Our data moat compounds along three dimensions:

1. **Decision archive:** Every memo, IC discussion, founder call, and post-mortem captured and structured. Within a year this is the queryable institutional memory; within three years it is unique IP.
2. **Relationship graph:** Every person, company, and interaction tagged and connected. Combined network of GPs + scouts + LPs + portcos + advisors becomes the substrate for customer intros, hiring help, and partnership matching.
3. **Outcome data:** Every deal — won and passed — tracked against forecasted outcomes. Calibrated judgment is the slow-compounding edge that no firm can copy quickly.

None of this is glamorous. All of it requires Day-1 discipline to tag, structure, and store. The temptation to defer it for “when we have more deals” is the single most predictable mistake we can avoid.

6. Team & Operating Cadence

6.1 Roles & responsibility split

Each person owns where their distinctive contribution is greatest, and supports elsewhere.

Role	Primary ownership	Supporting role
GP1 (Managing Partner)	Fund formation lead, LP relationships, IC chair, brand voice, founder relationships, Fund II positioning	Co-decision-maker on portfolio support and strategic deals
GP2 (Partner)	Fund operations, portfolio management lead, secondary fundraising support, IC member, deal execution	Co-decision-maker on all investments; backup on LP relationships
INV (Investment Intern, ex-VC)	Sourcing, DD execution, IC memo lead author, LP DDQ ownership, portfolio analytics, founder-facing operations	Brand content; LP CRM hygiene
TECH (Tech Intern)	AI infrastructure, data pipelines, internal tooling, sourcing automation, portfolio data, cybersecurity	Technical DD on AI/ML deals; founder portal

6.2 Operating cadence

Daily

Async standup: yesterday / today / blockers. Five minutes max. Discipline matters more than length.

Weekly Monday — Pipeline Review

60-min team meeting at the start of the week.

Two pipelines reviewed: LP pipeline (every conversation by stage) and deal pipeline (every active deal by stage).

Each gets specific next actions with owners and dates.

Weekly Thursday — Investment Committee (Not needed now)

Deals with completed DD packages go to IC. Pre-reads required 48 hours prior, non-negotiable. Format: 5-min recap by lead, 20-min discussion, decision, calibrated forecast logged. We will time-box rigorously.

Biweekly Friday — Builder Sync

TECH presents what shipped, what's next, what evals show. GP2 and INV in attendance. This is the only time-boxed feedback loop on the AI infrastructure — protect it.

Monthly — Plan-vs-Actual

Half-day review of this workbook. Update Status column. Surface slips honestly. Re-prioritize. The plan is not a performance review of past commitments; it is a tool for the future. We will be ruthless about cutting tasks that are no longer high-leverage.

6.3 Working norms

- **Async by default.** Synchronous time is for decision-making and relationship-building. Status and information flow asynchronously.
- **Document decisions, not discussions.** The decision and its rationale go into the system of record; the discussion does not.
- **Disagree and commit.** Once a decision is made, the team executes it. Reopening decisions burns the team's attention budget.
- **Founder-facing first.** When time is tight, founder responsiveness wins. Process can wait; founder trust cannot.
- **Show, don't tell.** Especially on AI. Demos beat decks internally and externally.

7. Top Risks & Mitigations

7.1 Fundraising stalls below first-close target

Likelihood high, impact severe.

Mitigation: Go full pedal!

Consider a step-down fund size threshold for first close (e.g., “we will do a first close at \$X with anchor in hand, even if below target”).

7.2 Thesis is indistinct, AI is commoditized

Likelihood high, impact severe. “AI” as a positioning is dead.

Mitigation: anchor on a durable sub-thesis (applied AI in a vertical we know deeply; AI infrastructure at a specific layer; AI-native operating advantage as the firm-level edge). LPs and founders must be able to name what's different in under 30 seconds. We will pressure-test this monthly until it lands.

9. KPIs & Success Metrics (TBC)

Category	Metric	Target by Month 12
Fundraising	First close achieved	\$X (40–60% of target) by M6
Fundraising	Final close achieved	Fund target by M12
Fundraising	LP meeting count (cumulative)	200+
Fundraising	Anchor LP commitments	1+ secured by M6
Sourcing	Qualified opportunities (per quarter)	200+ by Q4
Sourcing	Inbound vs. outbound mix	≥30% outbound by Q4
Sourcing	Time from inbound to first response	<48 hours, 95%+ compliance
Deals	Investments closed	5–7
Deals	Average days from first meeting to term sheet	<30
Deals	Average DD package quality score (internal review)	≥4/5
Portfolio	Founder NPS (anonymous, quarterly)	≥50 by Q4
Portfolio	Customer intros delivered per portco	≥3 / quarter
Portfolio	Portco monthly metrics completeness	≥80% by Q4
AI / Operations	Brief generator factual accuracy (eval)	≥95% on held-out set
AI / Operations	Hours saved per partner per week (estimated)	≥10 hours
AI / Operations	Sourcing model precision @ top-20	≥40% partner-validated fit
LP relationship	Quarterly letters sent on time	100%
LP relationship	LP information requests answered within SLA	100%
LP relationship	K-1 delivery by April 15	100%
Team	Plan tasks on schedule (rolling 90-day)	≥80%
Team	Team retention	100%
Team	Self-reported sustainability (quarterly check-in)	Green for all four

The full KPI dashboard will be built as a tab in our internal reporting system by Month 4, with monthly review at the plan-vs-actual session.

10. Appendix

10.1 Glossary

- **AGM:** Annual General Meeting — yearly LP meeting where the firm presents fund and portfolio updates.
- **Anchor LP:** An early, large LP commitment that signals validation and helps catalyze the rest of the fundraise.
- **Carry:** Carried interest — the GP's share of profits, typically 20%, paid after returning capital and any hurdle.
- **DDQ:** Due Diligence Questionnaire — standardized document LPs use to diligence GPs. ILPA-standard format is most common.
- **DPI / TVPI / IRR:** Distributions to Paid-in Capital / Total Value to Paid-in / Internal Rate of Return — primary fund performance metrics.
- **ERA:** Exempt Reporting Adviser — SEC status for smaller VC advisers, lighter filing burden than full RIA registration.
- **GP commit:** GP's own capital invested in the fund, signaling alignment with LPs. Typically 1–2%.
- **Hurdle / preferred return:** Annual return LPs receive before GPs earn carry. 8% is common; emerging funds sometimes negotiate lower or none.
- **IC:** Investment Committee — body that makes the final go/no-go decision on every investment.
- **LP:** Limited Partner — investor in the fund.
- **LPA:** Limited Partnership Agreement — the foundational legal document governing the fund.
- **MFN:** Most-Favored-Nation — clause giving an LP the right to elect into terms granted to other LPs via side letter.
- **NPS:** Net Promoter Score — single-question loyalty metric. Useful for tracking founder relationship quality.
- **PPM:** Private Placement Memorandum — disclosure document accompanying LPA in the fundraise.
- **RAG:** Retrieval-Augmented Generation — LLM technique that grounds responses in a specific document corpus.
- **RIA:** Registered Investment Adviser — full SEC registration required above certain AUM thresholds (typically \$150mm).
- **Side letter:** Bilateral agreement between fund and LP that modifies or supplements the LPA for that LP.

End of document